

One Home

The living room of the future will still serve as a family entertainment room, and will divide all content, whether from satellite channels or from your own PC, into audio and video. These audio and video streams will be sent to unified audio and video output devices.

Since speakers are meant to be heard and not seen, you will be able to install hidden speakers throughout your house that will act as the audio output devices. Volume and settings will be visually controlled via the room's video output device. More likely, however, is that your walls themselves will become your speakers; or for that matter, perhaps the ceiling as well—talk about surround sound!

Perhaps, much further in the future, we will be able to install paper displays that can cover our entire walls as wallpaper, and give us the freedom to demand the appearance of a screen, of any size, on any part of a wall or ceiling.

However, for now, we'll stick to the already-popular LCD screen that can cover one wall of each room and act as a visual output device for entertainment, computing, and as a graphical user interface (GUI) for changing the settings of all other devices. One such display device can be installed in every room of

the house, and the device will connect to all others in the house wirelessly. The device will be controlled by the house CPU, and will automatically follow you as you move around the house—switching on displays when someone enters a room, and switching off once everyone leaves.

The Hallway/Entrance

The logical place for the main home security panel is somewhere near the front door, so why mess with logic? This will merely control the security settings of the house, such as turning on or off the movement sensors outside, setting the burglar alarm, and auto-locking the house at predefined times. All these settings will also be accessible from anywhere else in the house using touch-sensitive video output devices, and entering the correct username and password combinations.

The main CPU will govern the security settings as well as other important semi-AI functions, such as privacy and data synchronisation.

When watching a movie or having dinner with your family, the house will automatically recognise that the entire family is involved in a particular activity, and will automatically screen calls and e-mails.

